

HOUSE JOINT RESOLUTION 867

By Moon

A RESOLUTION to honor the memory of Loretta Kuhn Cate.

WHEREAS, the members of this General Assembly were greatly saddened to learn of the passing of Loretta Kuhn Cate; and

WHEREAS, Mrs. Cate was an exemplary public servant and consummate professional who worked assiduously to improve the quality of life for her fellow citizens in numerous capacities; and

WHEREAS, Loretta Cate was born in Knoxville on March 16, 1956, and raised in Rock Island; her childhood was spent surrounded by family and playing outdoors, riding horses, and enjoying time on the lake; and

WHEREAS, from an early age, Mrs. Cate was loving, compassionate, and fiercely competitive; she graduated at the top of her class from Warren County High School in 1974; and

WHEREAS, Loretta Cate attended Lipscomb College, playing as the number-two seed for the women's tennis team during the 1974-1975 season after only learning how to play the sport the previous summer; and

WHEREAS, she transferred to the University of Tennessee, Knoxville, and after graduating, she attended the University of Tennessee College of Pharmacy, from which she graduated with highest honors; and

WHEREAS, Mrs. Cate's drive and incomparable work ethic paved the way for a highly successful professional career; she began at Vanderbilt Hospital as a pediatric pharmacist before transitioning into pharmaceutical sales with Parke-Davis; and

WHEREAS, she excelled in every role she held, becoming the top district manager and regional manager, the human resources manager, and, ultimately, the director of leadership development, a post she held until her retirement in 2006; and

WHEREAS, in retirement, Loretta Cate founded her own company, Access Leadership Edge, where she collaborated on client projects and long-term initiatives alongside a diverse team of independent professionals; she also co-founded Women in Leadership Now and continued to work on these passion projects until shortly before her passing; and

WHEREAS, Mrs. Cate was a woman of deep faith and an active member of First United Methodist Church in Maryville; and

WHEREAS, Mrs. Cate showed Tennessee Walking Horses and won a world championship at the Tennessee Walking Horse National Celebration in Shelbyville; she shared this passion with her two daughters; and

WHEREAS, Loretta Cate was deeply devoted to her family, and she always endeavored to remain true to family values of the highest order; her greatest joy was being with her children and grandchildren; and

WHEREAS, she will be sadly mourned but fondly remembered by her husband of forty-three years, Leslie Cate; daughters, Ashley Cate (Patrick Maximilian) Vogel and Lindsey Cate (John Christopher) Salter; granddaughters, Elizabeth (Elle) Jacqueline Vogel, Vada June Vogel, and Penelope Cate Salter; brothers, Charles William Kuhn, Jr., and Michael Roy Kuhn; and a host of beloved nephews and cousins; and

WHEREAS, she was preceded in death by her parents, Charles William Kuhn and Maxine Kuzzar Drake; and

WHEREAS, Loretta Cate leaves behind an indelible legacy of integrity and probity in public life, compassion and loyalty in private life, and diligence and dedication in all her chosen endeavors; and

WHEREAS, it is fitting that the members of this General Assembly should remember the bountiful life of this exceptional public servant and human being; now, therefore,

BE IT RESOLVED BY THE HOUSE OF REPRESENTATIVES OF THE ONE HUNDRED FOURTEENTH GENERAL ASSEMBLY OF THE STATE OF TENNESSEE, THE SENATE CONCURRING, that we honor the memory of Loretta Kuhn Cate, reflecting fondly upon her impeccable character and her stalwart commitment to living the examined life with courage and conviction.

BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED, that we extend our sympathy and offer our condolences to the family of Mrs. Cate.

BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED, that an appropriate copy of this resolution be prepared for presentation with this final clause omitted from such copy and upon proper request made to the appropriate clerk, the language appearing immediately following the State seal appear without House or Senate designation.